

Module: English Language and Literature

Topic: Elements of Style, Syntax, and Figurative Language

1. Literary Devices and Figurative Language

Writers use literary devices to look beyond the literal meaning of words and create more vivid imagery or emotional depth for the reader.

- **Metaphor:** A direct comparison between two unrelated things without using "like" or "as."
 - *Example:* "The classroom was a zoo."
- **Simile:** A comparison between two things using the explicit words "like" or "as."
 - *Example:* "He was as brave as a lion."
- **Personification:** Assigning human qualities, emotions, or actions to non-human objects or abstract concepts.
 - *Example:* "The wind whispered through the trees."
- **Hyperbole:** An intentional and extreme exaggeration used for emphasis or comic effect.
 - *Example:* "I have a million things to do today."

2. Common Grammatical Errors: Run-on Sentences vs. Comma Splices

Achieving proper sentence structure is essential for clarity in English writing. Two of the most frequent errors involve joining independent clauses incorrectly.

An **independent clause** is a group of words that contains a subject and a verb and expresses a complete thought. It can stand alone as a sentence.

- **Run-on Sentence:** This occurs when two or more independent clauses are joined together without any punctuation or coordinating conjunctions.
- **Comma Splice:** This happens when two independent clauses are joined together with *only* a comma.

How to Fix Them:

There are three standard methods to correct a comma splice or run-on sentence:

1. **Separate them:** Turn them into two separate sentences using a period.
2. **Use a Coordinator:** Connect them using a comma followed by a coordinating conjunction (the **FANBOYS**: *For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So*).
3. **Use a Semicolon:** Join them with a semicolon if the two thoughts are closely related.